

GNU Emacs: How to Work with HTML Mode, Indentation and Magit

In this latest article in our well-documented series on GNU Emacs, the reader is taken on a journey through HTML mode, indentation in HTML code and Magit — the magic interface to Git, inside Emacs.



This article in the GNU Emacs series takes readers on how to use HTML mode, do indentation, and use the Magit interface.

HTML mode

You can use HTML mode to effectively edit HTML and CSS files using GNU Emacs. To start the mode, use *M-x html-mode*. You will see the string 'HTML' in the mode line.

Default template

A default HTML template can be started by opening a *test.html* file, and using *C-c C-t html*. It will produce the following content:

```
<html>
<head>
<title>
```

You will then be prompted with the string 'Title:' to input the title of the HTML page. After you type 'Hello World', the default template is written to the buffer, as follows:

```
<html>
<head>
<title>Hello World</title>
</head>
<body>
<h1>Hello World</h1>
<address>
```

```
<a href="mailto:user@hostname">shakthi</a>
</address>
</body>
</html>
```

Tags

You can enter HTML tags using *C-c C-t*. GNU Emacs will prompt you with the available list of tags. A screenshot of the available tags is shown in Figure 1.

The anchor tag can be inserted using 'a'. You will then receive a message prompt: 'Attribute:'. You can provide the value as 'href'. It will then prompt you for a value, and you can enter a URL, say, *http://www.shakthimaan.com*. The anchor tag will be constructed in the buffer as you input values in the mini-buffer. You will be prompted for more attributes. If you want to finish, simply hit the *Enter* key and the anchor tag will be completed. The final output is shown below:

```
<a href="http://www.shakthimaan.com"></a>
```

You can insert a *h2* tag by specifying the same after *C-c C-t*. You can also add attributes, as required. Otherwise, simply hitting the *Enter* key will complete the tag. The rendered text is as follows:

```
<h2></h2>
```

You can insert images using the *alt* tag. You can specify the *src* attribute and a value for the same. It is also a good